

CPU and RAM you will obtain better performance from your machine. You may see improvement in various other applications like office suites, but to get optimum performance, all the components such as hard disk, motherboard and graphics card should be of good quality.

In your case, the graphics card is the bottleneck, not the CPU or the RAM. As far as gaming is concerned, the improvement in performance is more or less directly proportional to your graphics card. Even a Celeron 400 with a TNT2 card would be able to give 60+ frames per second in low to medium resolutions, but a Celeron 400 with a SiS 6326 will not even touch 10 fps, making the game practically unplayable.

You should upgrade to a better graphics card. We recommend going in for a GeForce2 MX, an economy-level graphics card available for approximately Rs 4,000 or slightly above.

Internet & Communications

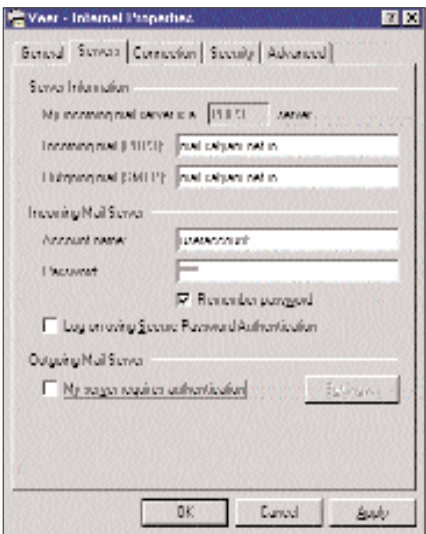
+ No go mail

I am unable to send mail using Outlook Express. The following error is displayed: "An unknown error has occurred. Account: 'satyam', Server: 'mail.satyam.net.in', Protocol: SMTP, Server Response: '502 unimplemented (#5.5.1)', Port: 25, Secure (SSL): Yes, Server Error: 502, Error Number: 0x800CCC64." However, I am able to receive mail. My ISP is Satyam Online.

Frederic St. Andre

Via e-mail

R The error shows that in the account settings, you have SSL enabled for the SMTP server (outgoing server). This needs to be disabled as the ISP does not support this kind of mail transfer. Open Outlook

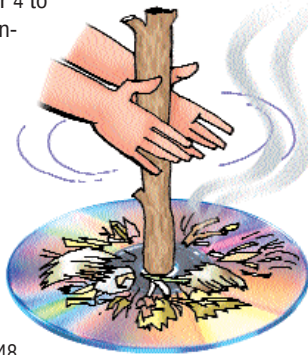


Configure your mail settings the right way

Applications

+ While the CDs burnt

I have connected my CD-R/W drive (16x/10x/40x) as the secondary slave. I have Windows 98 SE installed. I use Adaptec Easy CD Creator 4 to burn CDs, which was bundled with the CD-R/W. I have burnt 650 MB CD-Rs and CD-RWs and they are working fine, though in My Computer it showed the total size of the blank CDs as 648 MB. However, My Computer shows the size of blank 700 MB CD-Rs also as 648 MB, though the user manual of



my CD-R/W says that it is compatible with 700 MB CDs. How can I use the full 700 MB capacity of the CD-R?

Sachin Dalvi

Via e-mail

R The problem lies with your software and not your CD Writer. Easy CD Creator will burn 700 MB CDs but it will not show the data to be 700 MB while burning, as it cannot natively detect CDs of this kind. To solve this, it would be advisable to upgrade your software to the latest version or shift to another CD burning software such as Nero.

Express and click Tools > Accounts. Select Satyam and click on Properties. Switch to the Servers tab and under the Outgoing Mail Server area, uncheck the box marked 'My server requires authentication'.

Hardware

+ A reluctant printer

I have a P-III 600 MHz system with 192 MB SDRAM and Windows 98 SE as the operating system. My problem is that my computer hangs (and I'm forced to make a hard reboot) whenever I try to take a printout. It usually hangs after printing two-and-a-half or two-and-three-fourth pages. It occasionally has no problem in printing about four pages in economy mode. The timeout settings are set to a maximum of 60 seconds each. The printer LPT port properties show basic configuration 0000 with input/output range 0378 - 037F, 0778 - 077B, interrupt request 07 and Direct Memory Access 03 with no conflicts. I have tried reformatting and reinstalling the printer from the CD provided with the printer and even updating the printer driver from the Windows 98 CD and from the Internet. Please help me.

Jacob George

Via e-mail

R Go to your BIOS settings and check whether your parallel port is configured as ECP mode+EPP mode. Next, check whether your printer is assigned IRQ7 and whether any other hardware is utilising the same IRQ.

In case your printer is not assigned this IRQ, make sure you assign it and change the IRQ of any other hardware that uses it.

Windows and Internet & Communications

+ Of partitions and computers hanging

I have a P-III 667 MHz processor, 128 MB SDRAM, Intel 810i chipset and Windows 98 SE OS with FAT32 file system. I have three partitions: the primary DOS partition C: (5.16 GB), secondary DOS partition D: and extended DOS partitions E: (2.14 GB each). I would like to combine the two partitions of 2.14 GB into one. Can I do this without using third party utilities and without losing my data on the primary DOS partition?

I also have a problem with my 56 Kbps V.90 compliant modem. Whenever I connect to the Net with my Rolta Dialer, the modem connects at a speed between 30-40 Kbps. Also, when connected, my computer hangs. This happens every time I connect to the Net. My hardware vendor told me that there might be a conflict between my internal PCI modem and my PS/2 mouse, but there was none. He then replaced the motherboard as it might be faulty, but that did not help either. Please help.

Pranav Desai

Via e-mail

R To combine the data of the two partitions of your hard disk, you have to use a third party utility such as Partition Magic, which enables you to do this safely without losing your data.

About your second query, the problem is not with your motherboard but is most likely because of conflict with other hardware. Check for any sort of conflicts between your internal modem and any other hardware device such as the sound-card. If there is no conflict, you can try changing the PCI slot for your modem. If